

From: McCurdy,Christopher R
Sent time: 04/04/2024 11:52:02 AM
To: Matthew Lowe <mlowe@globalkratomcoalition.org>; Mac Haddow <mhaddow@americankratom.org>
Subject: Re: Letters of support Health Committee_2 April

Yes, they can be shared publicly.

Christopher R. McCurdy, Ph.D., F.A.A.P.S.
Associate Dean for Faculty Development
Professor of Medicinal Chemistry
The Frank A. Duckworth Eminent Scholar Chair
Director, UF Translational Drug Development Core
Department of Medicinal Chemistry
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1225 Center Drive
PO Box 100484
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From: Matthew Lowe <mlowe@globalkratomcoalition.org>
Sent: Thursday, April 4, 2024 10:56 AM
To: McCurdy,Christopher R <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>
Subject: Re: Letters of support Health Committee_2 April

[External Email]

Hi Chris,

Are we approved to share the FDA slides, or the information in them publicly?

Regards,

Matt

From: McCurdy,Christopher R <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>
Date: Tuesday, April 2, 2024 at 7:43 PM
To: JW Ross <jross@globalkratomcoalition.org>, Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU>
Cc: Matthew Lowe <mlowe@globalkratomcoalition.org>, Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>, Sharma,Abhisheak <asharma1@ufl.edu>, Mac Haddow <mhaddow@americankratom.org>, Erin Berthold <erinberthold@plantedinscience.com>, Bob Durkin <robert.durkin@agg.com>
Subject: Re: Letters of support Health Committee_2 April

Sorry, I forgot to attach the FDA slides, which I think you all should have!

Thanks,
Chris

Christopher R. McCurdy, Ph.D., F.A.A.P.S.
Associate Dean for Faculty Development
Professor of Medicinal Chemistry
The Frank A. Duckworth Eminent Scholar Chair
Director, UF Translational Drug Development Core
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From: JW Ross <jross@globalkratomcoalition.org>

Sent: Tuesday, April 2, 2024 12:32 PM

To: Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU>

Cc: Matthew Lowe <mlowe@globalkratomcoalition.org>; Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; McCurdy,Christopher R <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>; Sharma,Abhisheak <asharma1@ufl.edu>; Mac Haddow <mhaddow@americankratom.org>; Erin Berthold <erincberthold@plantedinscience.com>; Bob Durkin <robert.durkin@agg.com>

Subject: Re: Letters of support Health Committee_2 April

[External Email]

Good morning

Please note that im not aware of any 'ready to consume' kratom product (extract or whole leaf) in the market that does not have other 'substances' in it.

So the way this is drafted is that unless someone just eats the raw krarton leaf powder or eats the Kratom extract in its raw form (not currently available to consumers), they 'would' confer a higher risk profile consuming any product that is currently available for them to consume.

If this is your position then I would suggest that 'may' be changed to 'would' so that it's clear that thats your intent.

The reason this is so important is that if we have ambiguity its fertile ground for those who want to ban all kratom

JW Ross

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On Apr 2, 2024, at 7:47 AM, Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU> wrote:

Hello,

the only change I have made is to add the date to the statement above our signatures. Please use the attached version.

Best regards,

Oliver

From: Matthew Lowe <mlowe@globalkratomcoalition.org>

Sent: Tuesday, April 2, 2024 3:39 AM

To: Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; JW Ross <jross@globalkratomcoalition.org>

Cc: Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU>; McCurdy,Christopher R <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>; Sharma,Abhisheak <asharma1@ufl.edu>; Mac Haddow <mhaddow@americankratom.org>; Erin Berthold <erincberthold@plantedinscience.com>

Subject: Re: Letters of support Health Committee_2 April

[External Email]

Thank you all. Appreciate this statement.

In reference to the below discussion, from my read, the term '**may**' is used in the context of extracts, which conveys the view that this **is not a certainty**. Then moving onto mixing kratom substances the term '**would**' is used which conveys the view that **this is a certainty**, which is not necessarily the case especially if not explicit to what the other substance is.

Extracts products that contain multiple times the amount of mitragynine and other kratom alkaloids than are present in the native leaf material **may** produce a higher risk profile of adverse effects than whole-leaf products although there is currently limited clinical evidence supporting this claim. Likewise, kratom products that are pre-mixed with other substances **would** confer a higher risk profile than kratom leaf alone.

Would it not be more congruent to replace **would** with **may** in the context of extracts?

From: Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>

Date: Tuesday, April 2, 2024 at 2:12 AM

To: JW Ross <jross@globalkratomcoalition.org>
Cc: Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU>, Matthew Lowe <m Lowe@globalkratomcoalition.org>, Christopher R McCurdy <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>, Sharma,Abhisheak <asharma1@ufl.edu>, Mac Haddow <mhaddow@americankratom.org>, Erin Berthold <erincberthold@plantedinscience.com>
Subject: Re: Letters of support Health Committee_2 April

I suppose, yes. And good thing both would be in keeping with our statement of "would confer a higher risk profile" ---so we agree.

From: JW Ross <jross@globalkratomcoalition.org>
Date: Monday, April 1, 2024 at 8:08 PM
To: Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>
Cc: Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU>, Matthew Lowe <m Lowe@globalkratomcoalition.org>, Christopher R McCurdy <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>, Sharma,Abhisheak <asharma1@ufl.edu>, Mac Haddow <mhaddow@americankratom.org>, Erin Berthold <erincberthold@plantedinscience.com>
Subject: Re: Letters of support Health Committee_2 April

External Email - Use Caution

Isn't that exactly what I said ?

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On Apr 1, 2024, at 5:04 PM, Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu> wrote:

A general truth is more = more complexity. Polysubstance exposure is by definition always more complex and therefore more risky. There are few published data to support kratom products on the market (and certainly no published data to support a particular product), but like extracts, the more that a product deviates from the native leaf, the more complexity and risk. So, mixing kratom leaf with anything makes it stay further from nature. Not to say it is dangerous, but risky. Risk = uncertainty by definition.

From: JW Ross <jross@globalkratomcoalition.org>
Date: Monday, April 1, 2024 at 8:00 PM
To: Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU>
Cc: Matthew Lowe <m Lowe@globalkratomcoalition.org>, Christopher R McCurdy <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>, Sharma,Abhisheak <asharma1@ufl.edu>, Mac Haddow <mhaddow@americankratom.org>, Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>, Erin Berthold <erincberthold@plantedinscience.com>
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Well done!!!

Just have one question:

Likewise, kratom products that are pre-mixed with other substances would confer a higher risk profile than kratom leaf

Shouldn't this be 'could instead of 'would' since we won't know if it would until the science is done ?

As an example on feel free we have 4 years of safety data and the 1st clinical at 1/2 dose, but we really won't know the relative safety for sure until we get the results of our 2nd full dose clinical later this year

Maybe if you want to stick with would then you say 'dangerous substances' vs just substances

The way its currently written it could be interpreted as if you mix kratom and water it would confer a higher risk than just kratom leaf.

JW Ross
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On Apr 1, 2024, at 4:47 PM, Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU> wrote:

Dear all,

attached is a statement on the science of kratom that is signed by Kirsten Smith, Abhisheak Sharma, Chris McCurdy, and myself. It can be submitted for the CA bill to support the testimony I will provide. However, I am not speaking for Kirsten, Abhi, or Chris but will reflect what we all agreed on in this statement.

Thank you.

Oliver

From: Matthew Lowe <mlope@globalkratomcoalition.org>
Sent: Friday, March 29, 2024 12:30 PM
To: Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU>
Cc: McCurdy,Christopher R <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>; Sharma,Abhisheak <asharma1@ufl.edu>; Mac Haddow <mhaddow@americankratom.org>; JW Ross <jross@globalkratomcoalition.org>; Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>
Subject: Re: Letters of support Health Committee_2 April

[External Email]

Thank you Oliver. We are well aligned as to the below, and fully appreciate the position you have put forward.

I acknowledge your ask that the statement not be put forward as an explicit endorsement of the bill itself, and we will not use it in that way.

We appreciate your involvement in this and for agreeing to be a witness at the hearing. The same goes for Chris, Abhi and Kirstin.

Thanks,

Matt

From: Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>
Date: Friday, March 29, 2024 at 5:46 PM
To: Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU>, 'Matthew Lowe' <mlope@globalkratomcoalition.org>
Cc: McCurdy,Christopher R <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>, Sharma,Abhisheak <asharma1@ufl.edu>, Mac Haddow <mhaddow@americankratom.org>
Subject: Re: Letters of support Health Committee_2 April

Of note, the statement will be released to AKA as well as the Coalition at the same time.

This is not a statement with any "side-taking" but rather exactly like what Oliver described.

I am cc'ing Mac so that there is no "game of telephone" that occurs as Chris likes to say.

Everyone should be on the same page about this joint statement that we hope is helpful for *all* Kratom legislative efforts and education.

~Kirsten Smith, Ph.D.

Cell: 865-418-8177

ksmit398@jh.edu

(please forgive all typos; my phone hates me)

From: Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU>

Sent: Friday, March 29, 2024 11:41:58 AM

To: 'Matthew Lowe' <m Lowe@globalkratomcoalition.org>

Cc: Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; McCurdy, Christopher R <CMccurdy@cop.ufl.edu>; Sharma, Abhishek <asharma1@ufl.edu>

Subject: RE: Letters of support Health Committee_2 April

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Hi Matt,

as we had discussed, I am working on writing a statement to support the current science of kratom. This will be signed by Kirsten Smith, Chris McCurdy, Abhishek Sharma and myself.

Please be aware that this statement will be about the science of kratom and that we support sensible regulation in general. The statement and my testimony are not going to be specific to the CA bill – I am there to educate the committee on the scientific facts of kratom and our statement will make that clear as well.

So I ask that neither the statement of my testimony be advertised in any way or form as an endorsement of the CA bill. We are not in the business of policy making or lobbying. We are scientists and can educate and inform people.

Please acknowledge and we will send the statement to you by Monday.
Thanks and best wishes.

Oliver

From: Matthew Lowe <m Lowe@globalkratomcoalition.org>

Sent: Thursday, March 28, 2024 8:27 AM

To: Adam Wolf <adam@drinknewbrew.com>; Alex Wolf <alex@drinknewbrew.com>; david botanaway.com <david@botanaway.com>; Damarys Colon <dcolon@globalkratomcoalition.org>; eberthold@thekratomcoalition.org; Erin Berthold <erinberthold@plantedinscience.com>; Oliver Grundmann <grundman@UFL.EDU>; Jeremy Steding <info@1836kratom.com>; JW Ross <jross@thekratomcoalition.org>; Justin Wolf <justin@drinknewbrew.com>; Kelly Dunn <kelly@nvwsd.com>; Kirsten Smith <kirstenelins@icloud.com>; krdunn222@gmail.com; Kirsten Smith <ksmit398@jh.edu>; McGuffin Michael <mmcguffin@ahpa.org>; Patrick George <pgeorge@ka-pow.com>; Ramsey Atallah <ramsey.atallah@gmail.com>; Durkin, Robert <robert.durkin@agg.com>; Ryan Niddel <ryan@mit45.com>; ryan@ryanniddel.com; Soren Shade <soren@toptreeherbs.com>; Todd Underwood <todd@mitwellness.com>; Yin Zou <yizou@botaniconics.com>; Erin Berthold <eberthold@botaniconics.com>

Subject: Letters of support Health Committee_2 April

[External Email]

Hello All,

As we gear up towards the bill hearing on the 9th April, we need to gather letters of support for the bill from prominent people (Academics, Politicians, Public Health, Veterans etc.). We have requests out to a number of individuals, but are looking for more, especially if they are Californian based.

Can you please give some thought as to who in your networks might write a letter of support for the bill and send me a list of names by tomorrow?

Once received, Patrick will supply a draft letter that can be customised for each person.

The bill text is below for reference.

<https://trackbill.com/bill/california-assembly-bill-2365-public-health-kratom/2515626/>

Appreciate your support on this!

Thanks,

Matt